

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

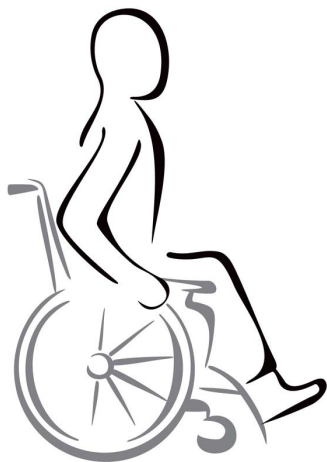
CONTENT

- Let's Start! • Let's Explore! • Let's Practice! • Extension Activity • Target Words • Learning Points



Let's Start!

Growing up with a disability can't be easy!



Learning Outcome

Describe hypothetical situations in written and spoken interactions according to work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- Do you know anyone who has a disability? Who is it and what is their disability?
- How has your school and your city been adapted to help people with disabilities?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about friendship, relationships, feelings and reactions.
- I can tell stories and anecdotes and talk about experiences I've had or haven't had.
- I can speculate about the past.





Let's Explore!

George has been **blind*** his whole life!

* When you are "*blind*" you cannot see.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

George has had a simple life. He has always dressed in black pants, a white shirt, and a grey cardigan. He has always eaten a soft-boiled egg with two pieces of toast for breakfast.

He goes to the park on Mondays and Wednesdays, and to the library on Tuesdays and Thursdays. On Fridays he always visits his mother. On weekends he volunteers.

George hasn't had an easy life. It must have been difficult growing up blind. However, George hasn't complained. He's managed quite well in fact.

A few years ago, some local troublemakers decided George was an easy target. They may have decided that because he followed such a tight schedule. They must have thought that tripping him and taking his keys was a good plan.

They must have assumed that with the keys two of them could burgle his house. They must have thought they could keep him occupied.

Monday came. The boys waited. Oddly, George never showed up. For some unfathomable reason, he visited his mother that day!

George doesn't know what was supposed to happen that day. Only those boys who tried to rob him know the truth. Somehow it changed them. It showed them that it pays to be a good person. Now, all three are good citizens.

I have a degree in social work, Danny is in medical school, and Rob is a teacher. We still see George sometimes, feeding the pigeons, in the park.





Let's Practice!

The troublemakers try to take advantage of George.

Instructions: Read the text and circle all the sentences that express speculation about the past.

It must have been difficult for George growing up blind. However, George has never complained. Nevertheless, a few years ago, some local troublemakers decided George was an easy target. They may have decided that because he followed such a tight schedule. He basically did the same things every day. They must have thought that tripping him and taking his keys was a good plan. Also, they must have assumed that with the keys the two of them could burgle his house. The troublemakers went over the details of their plan. That day, they must have thought they could keep him occupied.



Let's Practice!

My friend didn't have a good experience at school.

Instructions: Read the definitions. Find the words in the word search.

- _____, a person who intentionally causes problems for other people.
- _____, to accept something as truth without question or proof.
- _____, a sweater which fastens at the front with buttons.
- _____, the intended recipient of an attack.
- _____, impossible to understand.





Extension Activity

Talk about a trick you played on someone.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think about a trick you played on someone and map out the events on a timeline.
- Note the person's feeling and reactions on the timeline.
- Note where you talk about has happened or happened.
- Use the timeline to recount the story aloud.
- Practice it several times so it becomes natural.
- Tell the story to a partner without your notes.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I map out events for a trick I played on someone on a timeline.

☐ ☐

I add vocabulary for feelings and reactions.

☐ ☐

I use the Past Simple and Present Perfect tenses.

☐ ☐

I retell the story aloud without notes.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **cardigan** (noun): a sweater which fastens at the front with buttons
e.g. He has always dressed in black pants, a white shirt, and a grey cardigan
- **soft-boiled** (adjective): used to describe an egg which has been boiled with its shell on, and which has been removed from the water while the yellow part is still soft
e.g. He has always eaten a soft-boiled egg with two pieces of toast for breakfast.
- **troublemaker** (noun): a person who intentionally causes problems for other people
e.g. Some local troublemakers decided George was an easy target.
- **target** (noun): the intended recipient of an attack
e.g. George was an easy target.
- **to trip** (verb): to lose your balance while walking or running
e.g. They must have thought that tripping him and taking his keys was a good plan.
- **to assume** (verb): to accept something as truth without question or proof
e.g. They must have assumed that with the keys two of them could burgle his house.
- **unfathomable** (adjective): impossible to understand
e.g. For some unfathomable reason, he visited his mother that day!





Learning Points

Speculating About the Past

You can use modals to talk about degrees of certainty and speculate about things in the past.

You use them to describe what is definite, probable, possible, or impossible from the speaker's point of view.

You can use *must*, *may*, *might*, and *could* to describe degrees of certainty.

You can use modals with the Present Perfect to talk about the possibility of a past event that is not clear in the present context.

Example:

*They **must have thought** they could keep him occupied.*

Look at the chart for the meanings of modals when speculating about the past:

Modal Phrase	Meaning
Must have	It is very likely
May have Might have Could have	It is possible

- *May have* has a slightly stronger meaning than *might have* or *could have*.
- You can add *not* to make a negative speculation (It *may not have been* true).

Examples:

- *They may have decided that because he followed such a tight schedule.*
- *They must have thought that tripping him and taking his keys was a good plan.*
- *They must have assumed that with the keys two of them could burgle his house.*
- *They must have thought they could keep him occupied.*

The Present Perfect Tense vs. The Simple Past Tense

You use the Present Perfect tense to talk about a past action or an action that began in the past that is connected to the present in some way.

You use the Simple Past tense to talk about many kinds of past events: short, quickly finished actions, longer situations and repeated events.

You can use the Present Perfect tense to talk about experience.

When you use the Present Perfect tense, you think about the past and present together.





Learning Points

There is some connection between what happened in the past and now.

For example:

I have learned English. = I learned English in the past and now I can speak English.

He has bought a painting. = He bought the painting in the past and now he has a painting.

It is common to use *for* and *since* when referring to time periods in the Present Perfect:

- You use **FOR** to talk about how long an action has been happening (a week, two days, five hours, six years, etc.)
- You use **SINCE** to talk about when the action started (2010, Monday, she was a child)

Usually, when you use the Simple Past tense, the time of the finished action is clear from the context or explicitly mentioned in the sentence.

For example:

Yesterday, I **went** to the store.

A few years ago, some local troublemakers **decided** George was an easy target.

It is clear when the action occurred. In this sentence we would not use the Present Perfect. (~~Yesterday, I have been to the store.~~)

Examples:

- *Monday came.*
- *The boys waited.*
- *Oddly, George never showed up. For some unfathomable reason, he visited his mother that day!*
- *George has had a simple life.*
- *He has always dressed in black pants, a white shirt, and a gray cardigan.*
- *He has always eaten a soft-boiled egg and two pieces of toast for breakfast.*

